

STAGE ELEVEN • TOOLS & TECHNOLOGY

FIRSTS

FAQ

Anticipated participant questions and suggested facilitator responses

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

BY AYOMIDE AYENI

FIRSTS • FAQ

Stage Eleven • Tools & Technology

PURPOSE

These are the questions that come up most often across cohorts of Stage Eleven, with a suggested facilitator response for each. Use these as a starting point, not a rigid script.

Frequently Asked Questions

Q1. What if I feel like I'm genuinely behind on basic tools everyone else already knows?

A: That feeling is extremely common and rarely accurate — most people have real gaps somewhere, just in different specific tools. This stage exists precisely to close those gaps without judgment.

Q2. Do I need to become an expert in Git to complete FIRST O16?

A: No. The goal is one genuine, basic action and enough literacy to not feel lost in a conversation with a technical team — not professional-level Git skill.

Q3. What if my automation attempt (FIRST O23) doesn't actually work?

A: A failed first attempt with a clear understanding of why it failed is a completely legitimate, valuable outcome. Automation rarely works perfectly on the first try, even for experienced people.

Q4. I already have strong opinions about AI tools, positive or negative — do I still need to do FIRSTS O17 and O18?

A: Yes, and especially if your opinion is strong in either direction. The goal is genuine, hands-on experience with a real task, which often meaningfully updates even a strongly held prior opinion.

Q5. What if I don't have the authority to actually change tools at my current job or school (relevant to O25–O26)?

A: Comparison and selection skills transfer even without immediate authority to implement a switch. Complete the exercise for a tool choice you do control personally, and keep the skill in mind for when you do have that authority.

Q6. Is it really okay to drop a tool I've used for years during the Tool Efficiency Audit (O30)?

A: Yes, if it's honestly no longer earning its place. Sunk cost, the time already invested, isn't a good reason to keep using something that's no longer genuinely serving you.